

9 Month Sleep Regression Survival — Action Checklist

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UNDERSTANDING THE REGRESSION

- ☐ **Understand the 9-Month Regression Signs:** Recognize that sudden frequent night wakings, nap refusals, shortened naps, and bedtime resistance indicate the 9-month regression rather than a sign you did something wrong as a parent.
- ☐ **Accept That This Regression Is Temporary:** Understand that the 9-month sleep regression typically lasts 2-6 weeks and represents a temporary neurological event that will end, not a permanent change to your baby's sleep.
- ☐ **Identify Separation Anxiety as the Night Waking Cause:** Understand that your baby's night wakings are driven by their new awareness of object permanence, making them anxious about you leaving and not returning during sleep.
- ☐ **Recognize Motor Milestone Practice During Sleep:** Understand that your baby may be practicing new skills like crawling or pulling to stand during partial arousals between sleep cycles, causing position changes and distress.

MANAGING SLEEP DISRUPTIONS

- ☐ **Avoid Sleep Training During This Regression:** Resist the urge to implement formal sleep training methods during this 2-6 week period, as your baby is neurologically incapable of consolidating sleep changes right now.
- ☐ **Make Only Temporary Schedule Adjustments:** Adjust your baby's schedule temporarily to manage the disruption without making permanent changes, since your baby's underlying sleep needs have not actually changed.
- ☐ **Help Your Baby Return to a Comfortable Position:** When your baby wakes crying after practicing motor milestones, help them return to a comfortable lying position so they can settle back to sleep more easily.
- ☐ **Manage the Nap Transition Overlap Carefully:** Adjust nap timing to address overtiredness created by the transition from 3 naps to 2, recognizing that some schedule chaos is expected during this period.

PROTECTING YOUR WELLBEING

- ☐ **Share Nighttime Duties with Your Partner:** Coordinate with your partner to split night wakings and caregiving duties so neither of you bears the full burden of the exhaustion alone.
 - ☐ **Prioritize Your Own Rest When Possible:** Accept that surviving this regression requires you to rest when you can, even if that means letting some household tasks go undone temporarily.
 - ☐ **Set Realistic Expectations With Your Support System:** Communicate openly with your partner and support network about the 2-6 week timeline so everyone has realistic expectations and can offer appropriate support.
 - ☐ **Focus on Protecting Your Sleep Foundation:** Concentrate on not creating new sleep problems during this period rather than trying to solve existing ones, knowing the regression will pass and sleep will improve.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.